

hurricanes, and floods... And you have to be careful because both are required. You cannot tell the developing world that I'm going to focus on climate change, whichever of the two types, at the cost of giving you a school for girls or a health centre. So that's the second big thing... [being] careful about not recognising the trade-offs that need to be made.

When you put these together, what we are trying to do is ... [a few] things in the evolution road map of the bank, prompted by the G20 before I came in. The first is to get a new vision and mission. The vision is to go from just poverty and prosperity to say, we want to create a world free of poverty on a liveable planet. That liveable planet [bit] allows us to widen the aperture through which we look at the world to include climate, pandemics, fragility and food insecurity—so you can dedicate your resources to the intertwined nature of these challenges. The second thing we've done is to

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“If countries introduce the right policy frameworks, the right regulatory frameworks, and the right basic principles of where they're going on a topic, it can reduce the investment you need to meet an SDG goal by half”

make it inclusive... [people] speak about inclusion to include marginalised people. That's important, but half of the world's population—women—are still not able to access the same opportunities that a man does... So I'm focussing on women and young people, because young people are the energy of the developing world, and we've got to give them quality of life and jobs.

Q: The New Delhi Declaration talks about reforming the World Bank and other MDBs to make them better. Apart from working on sustainable development goals (SDG), reforming MDBs has been one the key thrusts of India's G20 presidency. How will you deliver on that?

A: This whole reform of MDBs has been part of the G20 evolution framework. And India took it on and

said, 'Let's get something done during our year.' For a guy who's new to the institution, who sees the need for change, this is like getting wind in your sails. Because you get people contributing their thinking, you have to be careful to listen to everyone, then prioritise what you want to pick on and focus on that. My focus has been to get to the better bank. And the better bank idea is the vision and mission that we were talking [about], and then get the right partnerships going for this bank with other MDBs... so I just announced a partnership with the Inter-American Development Bank, focussing on the Amazon, the Caribbean climate situation, and digitised governance. And then, the private sector and its partnerships... we've announced the Private Sector [Investment] Lab. And Chandra [N. Chandrasekaran, Chairman] of Tata [Sons] has volunteered his time to be a part of it. That's to help get more private sector money into renewable energy in the developing markets... And then the third part... is getting better capital, re-sweating our balance sheet—the loan to equity ratio, hybrid capital portfolio guarantees, global public good funds... So we can sweat our balance sheet without losing our AAA rating. If I can do these three things—a clear vision and mission, good partners with a number of people, including crowdsourcing private finance money, and get the right capital work going—I think then we get the right to go back and look at a bigger bank, which is kind of what the N.K. Singh-Larry Summers report [suggests].

Q: How are you working towards making Bretton Woods institutions like the World Bank less Washington-dominated, and more open to receiving the ideas of the Global South?

A: I completely disagree with the Washington-dominated word... [At] the World Bank, 55 per cent of the employees are outside of the US... India has a huge office... Nigeria, Ethiopia, Peru, Jamaica, the Pacific Islands, Indonesia... these are big offices with dedicated people. So I don't subscribe to the Washington dominance. I think what they're referring to is this shareholding pattern of one part of the bank, in particular, the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD). And I think that's because of voting power. You shouldn't allow that to divert from the ability of management to connect with countries. [What] we do with every country is a three-year country partnership framework; it agrees with the country what the priorities for it are. That's not done in [Washington,] DC; it's done in New Delhi... Jakarta... Nairobi. That's the first link. The second link is, we put projects on the ground ... these are